

Win... mo?

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✉ I am an avid reader of your esteemed magazine. I have a suggestion for *Digit*. It would be a great idea if start conducting some sort of annual techfest; where upcoming talents can get a nice platform for launching their dreams. More than 50% of your readers are teenagers (my approximation) and many of them are doing something or the other for people around them in field of technology but many more of them aspire for some platform to perform where world can see them or hear them; there are existing platforms like Imagine Cup etc. but they are too high for them. Like many reality shows on TV which give chance to young singers or performers to showcase their talents, we in field of Computer Sciences should have some platform. I personally feel *Digit* has this capability (you are in habit of doing big things) to change lives of masses. I myself would love to participate in it.

Prateek Gupta

d That is a great idea Prateek. Rest assured that we are always exploring new ways to reach out to our readers, and interact with them.

Robert

✉ The september issue was great as always and I really enjoyed it. I have a very special thanks for your team. Thanks to you I am the champion of TCS IT WIZ Bhubaneswar edition for the 2nd consecutive year!

This time I got a Lenovo G230 along with a lot of other prizes. The laptop is OK - it only has a 12" screen. Now my old CRT looks bigger! Your efforts really help us students to learn about all the tech surrounding us. The Fast track on the history of computing really helped me. I have a suggestion to make: Why don't you release an External HDD annually, filled with all the important upgrades, software and the 12 issues in pdf (though at an extra price of course!)

It would be so helpful as I keep going mad at losing



the monthly DVDs which my friends borrow and then forget to return. It is also cumbersome to store all the DVDs and search for the particular issue when required. I know the *Digit* archive is helpful but it simply is a headache with all the DVDs and absence of some of them.

Moreover some of them even get damaged after a long time. Hence the Ext. HDD with an updating tool would be very helpful so that we can update the HDD monthly and store all the important updates in one place.

I am sure many readers will welcome this too.

Aurojyoti

d Congratulations on your win. If magazines ever start giving away external hard drives with their issues, we will be among the first to do so. Meanwhile, watch out for an archive of all previous *Digit* issues in the December DVD.

Robert

✉ I am one of the die hard reader of *Digit*. For last two years, I have not missed a single issue of *Digit*. Well, there are some questions in my mind which

1. Does installing two or more Operating Systems on a single system hamper its performance?

2. Keeping in mind GUI & multimedia with networking, which linux distro is the best out there? Please provide it, if you have not provided it yet.

Pratik

d When you install two or more Operating Systems, each Operating System will occupy a certain amount of space on your Hard Drive. The boot sequence will involve a step where you select the Operating System you wish to boot into. There is no real drop in performance in the system, unless you consider the amount of scratch disk space, or swap space used by some applications. You can however, cross-swap or allocate the partition of your other Operating System(s) as your scratch disk space. Linux is fundamentally made from a networking point of view, so almost any Linux distro is great with networking. The GUI for Linux is not a standard with every distro, and there are many GUIs available. KDE and GNOME are the most common. KDE has the most eye-candy. Linux Mint is a great distro that looks good, and plays most multimedia formats out of the box. However, Sabayon, which is in this month's DVD, also plays most formats out of the box too. It is a multimedia centric distro, so try it out and tell us what you think of it.

Aditya

✉ I'm a new fan of *Digit* magazine. A friend of mine recommended that I read this magazine. After reading it, I am also recommending this to my friends. One question that always strikes me is that computers only uses binary codes (1 or 2) to perform its work.

My question is that is it

possible to make a computer that uses digits, decimals or hexadecimals instead of binary? If yes than why they are not made earlier?

Sudhanshu Gupta

d Binary uses zeroes and ones, not ones and twos. This is because modern processors use a number of switches, and a zero or one stands for the on or off state of the switch. For more, have a look at the Computer Science lectures on our DVD. This has so far proved the simplest and most economical way to make computers. There are experiments where the light spectrum, electrons, and even bacteria are being used for computing, but these are still in the labs and a long way away from becoming mainstream, if they ever will.

Rossi

✉ Finally I recently jumped on the broadband bandwagon. Its been four years since I picked up the first magazine from a news-stand and since then I have not stopped reading your magazine. Each one of them have been outstanding. Yours is one of the best tech magazine publication. The videos provided by you, especially the TED videos are awesome. The Fast Track issues are simply great. It has become a great source of information. The October issue really rocked.

Well i have a few suggestions. Hope you will fix it in the future..

1. Please x 1000000000 times bring back the *Digit* Software Archive.

2. Its about time you guys changed the DVD interface. It is getting really boring :-(

3. Bring back the crossword.

That is all I am asking. Fulfill these wishes for me and I will be the happiest person on this planet.

Keep Rocking :-):-:-)

Maresh Bharadwaj

d Great to know that you got broadband. Visit us at www.thinkdigit.com, and you will find a lot of contests and giveaways. These are pretty regular, so sign up for our newsletter to stay